Standard: SECURITY-POL00005-STN00098
Driver: Joseph Wallace
Classification: Internal
Version: 1.0

Data Governance Standard

Contents

1. Overview
2. Scope
3. Statement
   3.1 Data Governance Committees, Responsibilities, Operations and Membership
   3.2 Data Governance Operating Committee (DGOC) Responsibilities, Operations, and Membership
4. Definitions
5. Responsibilities
6. Governing Policy
7. References
8. Document Properties
9. Document History

1. Overview

The Data Governance Standard outlines Adobe's internal framework designed to address all data processed by or on behalf of Adobe, and establishes mandatory requirements including handling, security, quality, and cataloguing controls. This Standard, supported by internal Policies and Standards referenced throughout, describes Adobe's commitment to implementing a consistent enterprise-wide Data Governance Program.

2. Scope

This Standard applies to all data that Adobe processes from the time the data is created, collected, or received by or on behalf of Adobe until the data is deleted or destroyed.

In scope are Adobe-managed environments which collect, store, use, disclose, share, transmit, or dispose of data. Specifically, this applies to Adobe's five data domains (also known as "Dataverses"): Customer, Back-Office, Product, Vendor, and Worker. Examples of data in each of these domains can be found here.

Customer data is governed by this Standard only to the extent it aligns with the obligations and responsibilities associated with Adobe's obligations and responsibilities as either a data controller/business or processor/service provider (or comparable terms) as defined by applicable data protection laws, as well as any relevant contractual obligations between Adobe and other parties. Such obligations may include, but are not limited to, following Adobe Customer ("Customer") instructions, or processing data only to provide services on a Customer's behalf when Adobe is acting as a Data processor or service provider (or equivalent designation).

3. Statement

Adobe's Data Governance program is designed to facilitate the security, trustworthiness, accessibility, and responsible use of Adobe's data. This program aims to improve business outcomes, reduce risk, and enable informed decision-making. Data Governance involves not only discovering and documenting Adobe's data but also protecting it. This would allow others to know where the data is, how to access it, what it means, and how it should be used to promote faster innovation and scale enterprise operations through data discovery and definitions.

Efficient management and utilization of Adobe managed data: Customer, Product, Vendor, and Employee data are critical for value creation and risk mitigation. As a result, Adobe Workers are expected to follow requirements, to manage expanding data complexity, to demonstrate responsible data handling, and to meet internal and regulatory standards. For examples of data in each category, see the Dataverses under "Adobe Data Universe" on the Data Governance SharePoint site.

This Standard intends to provide guiding principles to Adobe workers based on business, contractual, and regulatory requirements. Across all the stages of the data lifecycle, there are various data governance process activities which Adobe must adhere to. These data governance activities can change over the data and system life cycle. The Data Governance process requirements are as follows:

A) Data Inception: Data inception is an event where data is created and/or collected for various purposes like training production models, operations, maintenance, planning, reporting, created and/or collected and/or licensed etc.

1. If data is collected, it must be obtained through lawful and responsible means and applied data minimization principles.
2. The data collection architecture must undergo either an architecture review board (ATS) or Privacy and Security review to assist with meeting statutory, business, and contractual requirements.
3. Data must have a designated Governance champion as defined in the Data Stewardship Wiki.
4. Data must be labeled in accordance with the Data Classification and Handling Standard (DC&H).
5. Data must be registered in the data catalog within 180 days of creation. The data catalog platform facilitates the sharing of data and insights across the enterprise, providing a single source of reference to search. Data stewards must register data assets in the data catalog and maintain the data dictionary based on data taxonomy, business terminology, and data models.

B) Data Processing and Consumption: Data processing is a series of operations on data to turn it into usable information, insights or analytics.

1. Access control must be in place to ensure that only authorized users have access to the required storage systems, as defined in the Logical Access Account Standard.
2. Efforts must be made to design the services in accordance with data architecture requirements for back-office data posted by the Architecture Review Board (ARB).
3. Adobe Workers must deploy necessary tools and procedures to maintain good data quality and consistency.
4. Necessary role-based access provisions must be made to follow the principle of least privilege.
5. Adobe Workers must follow the data backup and archiving procedures as specified in the Data Backup and Restore Standard.

C) Data Deletion:

1. Adobe Workers must implement the organization's approach to data retention and deletion in accordance with Consumer Personal Information Retention Standard (CPIRD) or global non-PII data retention periods. They must follow Adobe's data retention and deletion standards and policies by keeping data only as long as required, using approved systems and securely deleting information no longer needed.
2. Data Deletion must take place as per the Secure Data Deletion Standard.

3.1 Data Governance Committees, Responsibilities, Operations and Membership

3.1.1 The Data Governance program is co-led by the Chief Information Officer, Chief Privacy and Cybersecurity Legal Officer, and Chief Security Officer. **Data Governance Steering Committee (DGSC)** must be set up to provide oversight, which is co-chaired by the above three with membership from DX, DME, Finance, and corporate functions. In addition to the steering committee, a **Data Governance Operating Committee (DGOC)** must be set up with an execution focus.

3.1.2 The DGSC provides oversight of the Program and has the following responsibilities:

3.1.2.1 Oversight of data quality and consistency:

- Determines approach regarding topics such as data retention, access controls, deletion, backup, archiving, data loss prevention (DLP), data architecture and repositories, data mapping, data labeling, data classifications, and data handling.
- Selects specific priority projects within the topical coverage areas, develops those, and signs off on significant amounts of residual risk in particular business units or functions.
- Provides subject matter expertise input from IT, Security, Privacy, RAAS and BU perspectives on Data Governance initiatives and use cases.
- Reviews and opines on standalone data governance policies, standards, procedures, and guidelines or data governance principles embedded in other substantive documentation; a senior BU representative may request exceptions to a data governance requirement by presenting to the DGSC.
- Monitors progress and provide strategic guidance regarding the Program.
- Commits business support.
- Reinforces a culture of appropriate data governance for Adobe workers.

3.1.2.2 Consulted: The DGSC is consulted on the following:

- Material operational or technical changes impacting the Program
- Proposed testing plans

3.1.2.3 Informed: The DGSC is informed of the following:

- Material changes to Critical Data Asset Inventory
- Material data breaches and lessons learned
- The status of our data controls
- Relevant legal developments
- Material Audit or Tech GRC findings related to the Program
- Other reviews, as appropriate

3.1.2.4 Membership:

- The DGSC has the following standing members:
- Chief Information Officer
- Chief Privacy Officer & Chief Cyber Legal Officer
- Chief Security Officer
- Risk Advisory and Assurance Services (RAAS)
- DMe senior representative(s)
- DX senior representative(s)
- Finance senior representative(s)

3.1.2.5 Senior members Invited on a need-to-know basis:

- Growth Marketing and Strategy – VP, Growth Marketing & Insights, Corporate Marketing
- BU Legal (Head of DMe, DX, ILX)
- Function Coverage Legal (e.g., Head of Corporate, Employment, Compliance, IP)
- Employee Experience
- Third Party Risk Management (TPRM) Procurement

3.2 Data Governance Operating Committee (DGOC) Responsibilities, Operations, and Membership

3.2.1 The DGOC provides operational execution and reporting of the Program and has the following responsibilities:

- Reviews data governance priorities, objectives, and decisions made during Steering Committee meetings; prioritizes newly identified opportunities in their project funnels and creates well-lit paths of intake.
- Advances data governance objectives by executing on the goals set forth for the quarter.
- Aligns resources from the respective teams to the priorities and objectives.
- Is accountable for achievement of Enterprise Data Governance shared program Objectives and Key Results (OKRs), tracking of milestones, and status reporting provided by the DGOC.
- Implements solutions driven by the data governance team such as data retention, access controls, deletion, backup, archiving, DLP, data architecture and repositories, data mapping, data labeling, data classifications, and data handling.
- Drives execution of specific priority projects, addresses risks, and escalates to the DGSC as needed.
- Advocates for and influences data projects, investments, and resources within the respective BUs and functions.
- Identifies and elevates pain points and data governance opportunities to the DGSC.
- Remains active and visible to the Program.
- Is responsive to DGOC's escalations and provides decisions as needed.
- Supports Data Stewardship structure and owned data domains (to be developed).
- Identifies data issues and opportunities within the function and raises them to the DGOC monthly.

3.2.2 Operations

3.2.2.1 The DGOC meets monthly or more frequently as needed.

3.2.2.2 If DGOC members cannot attend, a delegate will attend the meeting.

3.2.2.3 The meeting agenda is approved by the chair with input from DGOC. Meeting minutes are maintained and distributed by the DGOC Lead.

3.2.3 Membership

3.2.3.1 The DGOC consists of assigned representatives from functional areas across each BU, Data Domain Leaders and Stewards, and delegates from each of the core members of the DGSC.

3.2.3.2 Membership of the DGOC may be proposed by Senior Leadership.

3.2.3.3 The current list of members is documented and kept by the Sr. Director of Data Governance.

4. Definitions

Term	Definitions
Availability	Data and information systems are available when required.

Term	Definitions
Adobe Worker	Current and former regular employees, applicants, Adobe-paid temporary employees, contingent workers and interns.
Confidentiality	Facilitate process where data or information system is accessed by only an authorized person.
Data Catalog	Inventory of data assets across the organization in one place for users to discover, understand, trust, access, with data/asset ownership. Additional information can be found in the Data Catalog Position Paper.
Data Classification	The process of organizing data into categories based on its sensitivity, value, and regulatory requirements.
Data Deletions	Deletion of data (e.g., terminated customers with no current entitlements) to reduce risks to Adobe, including legal risks, security risks, and poor customer experience risks.
Data Element Registration	Tracking and managing data assets throughout their lifecycle to maintain a record of assets, enabling effective monitoring, valuation, and financial reporting. Platform/Tool offers end-users the ability to search, enrich, enable, observe and contribute their data to various targeted systems in Adobe.
Data Governance	Data Governance is the management of data throughout its lifecycle from creation or collection to use and eventually disposal, considering the people, processes and technology required to manage and protect that data.
Data Governance by Design	Embedding Data Governance principles and practices where possible to take a proactive approach to complying with data governance policies.
Data Lifecycle	Refers to the stages the data goes through from creation/collection to transformation to processing to storage to encryption/decryption to deletion.
Data Literacy	Enable Adobe users to consciously look for and leverage the right information to aid in one's experience and expertise in day-to-day decision-making; applicable across all functions and levels.
Data Mapping	The process of data mapping involves tracking, documenting, and integrating various data elements (data sources, data fields, data systems, data warehouses, etc.).
Data Minimization	The practice of collecting, processing and retaining only the minimum amount of personal data necessary to achieve a specific purpose.
Data Retention	Intentional storage of data for a specific period as required by compliance, regulatory, and/or business requirements.
Data Veracity	Data Veracity refers to the accuracy, reliability and trustworthiness of data thereby integrates risk and relevance alongside data quality.
DG Foundations – Policies, Standards & Procedures	Repositing policies, standards, and procedures across the data governance capabilities, program, and projects.
Protected Backups	Facilitate process for user generated content to be protected based on a consistent set of data protection standards and monitoring technologies and provide assurance of recoverability of the data.

5. Responsibilities

Group	Responsibilities
Data Governance Operating Committee Members	▪ Provide consulting and execution pathways on governance activities, reporting on compliance, and initiates governance activities after documentation is complete. Recruit data governance champions - to

Group	Responsibilities
	drive adherence to governance standards, drive adoption across business units, and act as liaisons between the operating committee and data teams.
Data Governance Steering Committee Members	▪ Provide oversight of Adobe's Data Governance program in relation to all business units (DMe and DX) and functional areas (e.g., ATS, LSP, marketing, etc.) to facilitate compliance with and ensure consistent implementation of the Program.
Data Governance Champions	▪ Responsible for ensuring that data is compliant with the Data Governance Standard and provides business context and the problem to be solved through governance.
Data Champions	▪ Advocate for responsible data practices within their teams, helping to build awareness, encourage adoption, and ensure alignment with enterprise standards. They support the accuracy and consistency of data by raising data quality issues and collaborating with data stewards and technical teams to improve data use and understanding across the organization.

6. Governing Policy

Adherence to the governing Policy referenced below is required to be compliant with this Standard. All Adobe Technology Policies and Standards can be found on the Inside Adobe Technology Policies and Standards site:

- Information Security Policy

7. References

- Hosting Standard
- Customer Personal Information Retention and Deletion Standard (CPIRD)
- Data Classification and Handling Standard
- Logical Access Account Standard
- Personal Information Retention and Deletion Policy
- Secure Data Deletion Standard

8. Document Properties

PSOP Lead	Ensures Review, Approval and Publication; Facilitates Discussions	Anastasia Conti (Manager, Governance, Tech GRC)
Driver	Subject Matter Expert; Owner of Content; Works with Contributors	Joseph Wallace (Director, Data Governance)
Approver	Approves Document	Sonali Bhagwat (Sr. Director, Data Governance and Security Solutions)
Contributors	Provides Recommendations; Subject Matter Expert; Critical Reviewer	Click here for Contributor list
Informed	Notified of Publications	Click here for Informed list

9. Document History

Version	Approval Date	Changes	Approved By
1.0	December 2025	• Initial publication of Data Governance Standard	Sonali Bhagwat, Sr. Director, Data Governance and Security Solutions